STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURE	G-4500

	SARPY COUNTY SHERIFF'S OFFICE PAPILLION * NEBRASKA **GREG LONDON** **SHERIFF**	DATE ISSUED 12/04/06	DATE REVISED **12/30/21**	DATE REVIEWED 02/02/25
		APPROVED: *GREG LONDON*		

CHAPTER TITLE GENERAL	RESOURCES CALEA 82.1.6
SUBJECT COMPUTERS	CROSS REFERENCE

I. Purpose:

The purpose of this policy is to ensure the proper use of Sarpy County Sheriff's Office computers, including internet use and e-mail.

II. Policy:

Sheriff's Office computers are the property of Sarpy County. Users are required to comply with this policy, all applicable user manuals, directives and other policies related to Sheriff's Office computers. Any violation of this policy may subject the employee to disciplinary action.

Sheriff's Office computers are intended for official use and are not to be used for purposes other than conducting official county business. The county e-mail system is intended for routing official communications and is not to be used to send junk mail, "for profit" messages, chain letters or any communication containing inappropriate content. Attempts to forge, plagiarize or misrepresent an electronic file created by another user are prohibited.

III. Definitions:

A. SHERIFF'S OFFICE COMPUTER: County owned computer hardware, software, data, networks, programs, systems, and related property.

B. E-MAIL: Electronic messaging system.

C. INTERNET: An interconnected system of networks that connects computers around the world via the TCP/IP protocol.

D. INTRANET: A secured network restricted to a limited group of users.

E. **SCSO INTRANET:** An internal web site accessible only to designated employees. The site may contain information that is not to be disseminated to the general public.

F. **SCSO PUBLIC WEB SITE:** A web site accessible to the public providing information regarding Sheriff's Office activities.

G. **USER:** An employee permitted to operate Sheriff's Office computers.

H. **USER ID:** A user's logon account.

IV. Procedures:

A. **System Administration:** The system administrator, under the direction of division commanders, the Chief Deputy, and the Sheriff, shall assign user rights to files and software applications, and shall assign user IDs.

1. User IDs: Each employee shall be provided with a user logon and password. User passwords shall be kept confidential, and users shall not share passwords for any reason. Providing passwords may result in disciplinary action. Passwords are required to be changed on a regular basis. Notification is generated through an automated system that a password is set to expire. Generally, this notification is generated every 90 days. An audit of the password system shall be requested by the CALEA Unit annually.

2. Hardware and Software Installation: All installation of hardware and software shall be performed by the system administrator. Unauthorized personnel shall not load programs onto Sheriff's Office computers. Portable media (e.g. CDs, flash drives, etc.) brought from outside the Sheriff's Office shall be scanned for viruses by the system administrator prior to being accessed by Sheriff's Office Computers.

B. **Computer Use:**

1. An employee shall log onto Sheriff's Office computers only with his or her user logon and password. Employees are responsible for any activity initiated by their user logon account. If an employee determines there has been unauthorized use or violations on his or her user logon account, he or she shall immediately report the incident to his or her division commander, the Chief Deputy, or the Sheriff.

2. Users shall log off before leaving a computer unattended. Failure to log off a Sheriff's Office computer is the responsibility of the user, and the user shall be held responsible for any actions taken on the computer with their logon account.

3. An employee can be held in violation of this policy if he or she uses the logon access of another employee and is not authorized to do so. If an employee intends to use a computer where another employee has not logged off, he or she shall either not use that computer or he or she shall log off the other employee prior to using the computer. Employees shall not intentionally abuse another employee's logon access

4. All activity on Sheriff's Office computers is the property of Sarpy County and may be monitored.

5. The use of passwords to gain access to the computer system or to secure specific files shall not provide users with an expectation of privacy. Passwords used in the creation of e-mails or files shall be made known to the system administrator.

6. Users shall not intentionally develop, download, or use software that:

a) Identifies or bypasses computer system security mechanisms, discloses passwords, or enables unauthorized access to information.
b) Is designed to replicate or attach itself to other programs (e.g. worms, viruses) whether or not it has any malicious intent.
c) Is designed to bypass software or copying restrictions.
d) Attempts to or does consume all of the computer system's resources (e.g. memory, disk space, processing queues, or bandwidth).

7. Central records are stored on a server and automatically backed up on a nightly basis.

8. Files determined to be of a critical nature saved on a local computer drive shall be backed up by the employee who created the files. Backups may be performed onto external media (e.g. CDs, flash drives, etc.). Creating backup copies shall ensure that files are available in the event of a local hard drive failure. A request may be made to the system administrator to provide storage to a server for automated backup.

9. In the event of a problem with a Sheriff's Office computer, users shall contact the system administrator immediately.

C. Use of Sheriff's Office Laptop Computers and Other Portable Media:

1. Portable data belonging to Sarpy County in the possession of an employee stored on laptops, CD or floppy disks, flash drives, external drives, PDA's, or other portable media shall be strictly monitored by the employee to prevent data from being stolen or lost.

a) Data of a confidential nature shall not be transferred to computers that are not maintained by Sarpy County to prevent theft of the data.

2. Each employee issued a laptop is responsible for the security of that laptop and the data on the laptop, regardless of whether the laptop is used in the office, at the employee's place of residence, or in any other location.

a) Employees shall keep their laptops with them and in their sight or in a secure location at all times.

b) Where possible, employees should avoid leaving their laptops unattended in an automobile. If they must do so temporarily, the laptop shall be locked in the trunk.

D. **E-mail Use:** The Sarpy County Sheriff's Office considers e-mail an important means of communication and recognizes the importance of proper e-mail content in conveying a professional image for the Sheriff's Office. Users shall take the same care in drafting e-mail as they would for any other correspondence.

1. Sarpy County Sheriff's Office employees shall be required to check their email accounts during each duty shift.

2. Though e-mail seems less formal than other written communication, the same laws apply (e.g. libel, release of information, etc.). Therefore, users are prohibited from the following:

a) Creating, sending, or forwarding any e-mail containing libelous, defamatory, offensive, racist or obscene remarks.
b) Creating, sending, or forwarding confidential information without permission from a command officer.
c) Creating, sending, or forwarding information or messages that are the property of another user without permission of the user.
d) Creating, sending, or forwarding copyrighted material without permission.
e) Creating, sending, or forwarding an attachment containing a virus.
f) Sending or forwarding unsolicited e-mail (Spam).
g) Disguising or attempting to disguise one's identity when sending e-mail.
h) Sending e-mail using another user's account.

3. E-mail transmissions shall be routed through a designated e-mail application or using a browser on an offsite computer to log on to the secured mail server.

4. Generally, confidential information should not be transmitted via e-mail. If an employee is in doubt regarding specific information, he or she shall obtain approval from a command officer.

5. No user shall disclose, circulate, or transmit any official correspondence or confidential information to any unauthorized party.

6. Users may not encrypt any e-mails without obtaining written permission from the Administrative Commander. If approved, the encryption key(s) shall be provided to the system administrator.

7. Users shall delete all e-mail messages no longer needed and should set their e-mail account to automatically empty the "deleted items" folder upon logging off. Users shall not allow their e-mail accounts to become "full" to prevent further emails from being delivered.

E. **Internet Use:** Access to the internet must be authorized by the Administrative Commander.

1. The level of internet access shall be determined by the employee's division commander. The employee's division commander shall notify the Administrative Commander by memorandum regarding any requested change in the level of internet access for an employee. The Administrative Commander shall review the request and, if approved, shall forward it to Technical Support for implementation.

2. Users authorized access to the internet shall not allow unauthorized individuals access to the internet.

3. Internet resources shall be used appropriately and only for conducting official business.

4. Users shall not design or allow access to any unauthorized webpage or FTP (file transfer protocol).

5. Internet activity including playing games, posting on bulletin boards, instant messaging or sending e-mails not of an official nature is prohibited.

6. Internet resources shall not be used for personal gain, personal business, fundraising or mass mailings.

7. No political or campaign related material shall be transmitted via the internet or using a Sheriff's Office computer.

8. Internet access shall be monitored periodically to determine utilization and bandwidth requirements. Monitoring also indicates links and other information pertaining to internet resources accessed by individual users.

9. Complaints regarding e-mails or bulletin board postings made by a Sarpy County internet user shall result in the individual user account being suspended until an investigation is completed. Improper use of the internet may result in disciplinary action.

F. System Monitoring:

1. All messages distributed via the county's e-mail system are the property of Sarpy County. All e-mail accounts maintained on the county e-mail systems are the property of Sarpy County. All files created on county computers are the property of Sarpy County.

2. Users waive any right to privacy in anything created, stored, sent or received on the county's computer systems. The Sarpy County Sheriff's Office may, but is not obligated to, monitor e-mails and electronic files without prior notification. If an employee is not adhering to the guidelines set forth in this or other policies, he or she may be subject to disciplinary action.

3. Any monitoring of computer content and e-mail history may only be authorized by the Sheriff, Chief Deputy, Administrative Commander, or Investigative Commander.

G. Individually-Owned Electronic Devices:

1. Users who choose to use individually-owned devices (also referred to as "Bring Your Own Device" (BYOD)) to utilize programs, databases, and applications for Sheriff's Office purposes must comply with the Sheriff's Office terms of use and rules for those specific resources and the Sarpy County Information Systems IT Security policy.